@FLEXAPPEALFFL · 2026 SEASON · WEEK 9

THE FLEX APPEAL WEEKLY

Three weeks. Seven tickets. One bye.

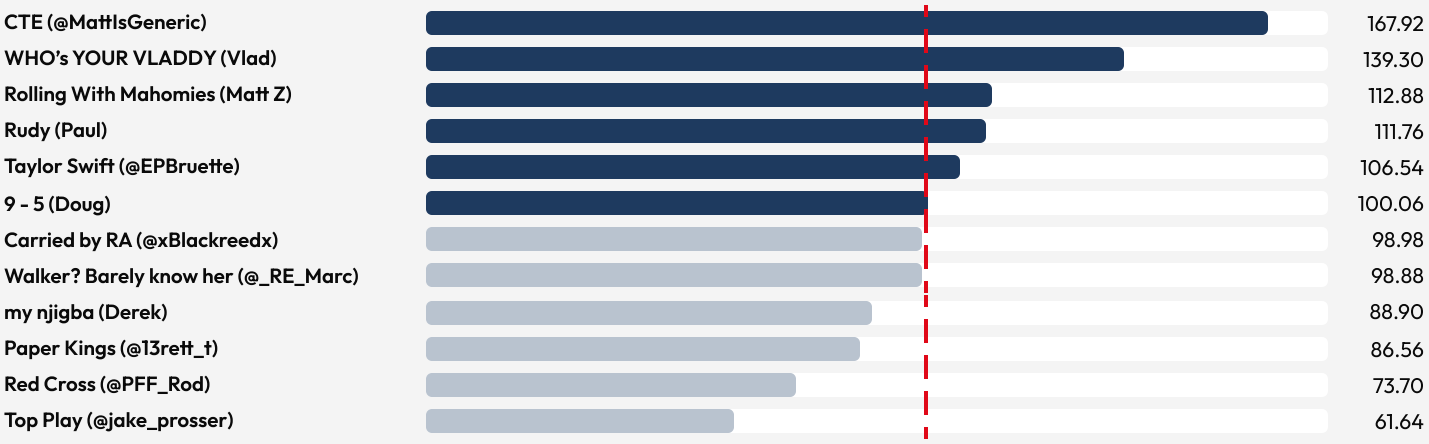
167.92	99.52	13-3	0-16
Matt A: Week 8 high	Week 8 median	Doug leads the field	The commissioner

The episode never made it to the microphone, so the playoff push comes to print. Eight weeks are complete, with three weeks and six results left: one head-to-head and one median result each week. The top seven make the playoffs in Week 12; only the No. 1 seed gets a bye. **The trade deadline is Week 9.**

WEEK 8: CTE TAKES THE WHEEL

CTE (@MattIsGeneric) detonated for 167.92, beating 9 - 5 (Doug) by 67.86 and taking the league lead in points for (967.36). Doug still cleared the median for a 1-1 week. Matt A went 2-0 — and vaulted to the top of the Flex board.

THE WEEK 8 SCOREBOARD



Dashed red line: median 99.52. Navy clears it; gray misses it. These are final scores.

H2H WINNER	SCORE	H2H LOSER	SCORE
CTE (@MattIsGeneric)	167.92	9 - 5 (Doug)	100.06
WHO's YOUR VLADDY (Vlad)	139.30	Rudy (Paul)	111.76
Rolling With Mahomies (Matt Z)	112.88	Top Play (@jake_prosser)	61.64
Taylor Swift (@EPBruette)	106.54	my njigba (Derek)	88.90
Carried by RA (@xBlackreedx)	98.98	Red Cross (@PFF_Rod)	73.70
Walker? Barely know her (@_RE_Marc)	98.88	Paper Kings (@13rett_t)	86.56

The cruel line: Andrew missed the median by 0.54 and Marc by 0.64, so both H2H winners split 1-1. Vlad's 139.30 beat Paul's 111.76; Paul salvaged a median win, also finishing 1-1. Lij swept both results to reach 12-4 and extend his streak to six straight results.

WEEK 9 FLEX RANKINGS

DRAFT · NOT PUBLISHED

#	TEAM (MANAGER)	REC	PF	EFF.	SCORE	MOVE
1	CTE (@MattIsGeneric)	11-5	967.36	90.5%	**2.53**	+5
2	9 - 5 (Doug)	13-3	953.06	89.8%	**3.08**	-1
3	Taylor Swift (@EPBruette)	12-4	925.92	86.3%	**3.70**	-1
4	Rolling With Mahomies (Matt Z)	11-5	897.30	90.8%	**4.25**	+1
5	Rudy (Paul)	10-6	940.70	89.5%	**5.08**	-2
6	WHO's YOUR VLADDY (Vlad)	7-9	905.02	89.8%	**6.33**	+4
7	Paper Kings (@13rett_t)	8-8	918.18	90.0%	**6.70**	-3
8	Carried by RA (@xBlackreedx)	5-11	768.36	91.0%	**7.48**	+1
9	Walker? Barely know her (@_RE_Marc)	10-6	889.76	84.6%	**7.88**	-2
10	my njigba (Derek)	7-9	850.28	89.5%	**8.50**	-2
11	Red Cross (@PFF_Rod)	2-14	674.98	85.4%	**11.10**	+0
12	Top Play (@jake_prosser)	0-16	647.36	86.5%	**11.40**	+0

Lower weighted score is better. Standings 25% · PF 20% · TDs 15% · efficiency 15% · point differential 10% · previous week 10% · streak 5%. Movement vs Week 8.

The climbers: Matt A jumps five spots to No. 1, with the league's best PF and point differential (+158.86). Vlad climbs four to No. 6 despite a 7-9 record. Marc's 10-6 record looks safer than his No. 9 ranking: last in lineup efficiency (84.6%) and tenth in starter touchdowns.

PAPER KINGS: FROM 8-2 TO FREE FALL

Paper Kings (@13rett_t) opened 8-2 and now sits 8-8. Six consecutive lost results have turned a contender into a bubble team. The scoring explains it:

133.0
PPG, Weeks 1–5

84.4
PPG, Weeks 6–8

52%
Modeled playoff chance

Henry, Purdy, Bijan and Watson have cooled off, while Montgomery and A.J. Brown landed on IR. The Oct. 10 deal has not helped: McLaurin and Brian Robinson have combined for 5.2 points since the trade, while Corum and Odunze are averaging about 23 per week for Juan.

Week 8 brought another lineup autopsy: Brissett scored 4.46, A.J. Brown zero and Bijan 7.6. Gainwell's 14.0 and Keenan Allen's 10.2 stayed on the bench. Marc won 98.88–86.56, the week's closest H2H game; neither cleared the median.

> **The escape hatch is Jake. A 2-0 Week 9 lifts Brett's modeled playoff odds to about 71%; an 0-2 week drops them to about 22%.**

A split leaves Brett around 43%. This is not a must-win in the mathematical sense. It is the week Paper Kings cannot afford to treat like a free square.

SEVEN SEATS. ONE WEEK OFF.

Doug is the clear favorite for the bye, but nobody has clinched the No. 1 seed. Lij is riding six straight results; Matt A has the points-for hammer. The regular season ends in Week 11, with wins then PF deciding seeding.

PLAYOFF PROBABILITY		BYE ODDS
9 - 5 (Doug) · 13-3	100%	59%
Taylor Swift (@EPBruette) · 12-4	99.9%	18%
CTE (@MattIsGeneric) · 11-5	99.5%	18%
Rudy (Paul) · 10-6	98%	1.6%
Rolling With Mahomies (Matt Z) · 11-5	97%	3%
Walker? Barely know her (@_RE_Marc) · 10-6	87%	0.2%
Paper Kings (@13rett_t) · 8-8	52%	—
WHO's YOUR VLADDY (Vlad) · 7-9	44%	—
my njigba (Derek) · 7-9	21%	—
Carried by RA (@xBlackreedx) · 5-11	~0%	—
Red Cross (@PFF_Rod) · 2-14	~0%	—
Top Play (@jake_prosser) · 0-16	0%	—

50,000 simulations after Week 8, not guarantees. Rounded odds; — means no bye estimate supplied. ~0% does not mean mathematical elimination.

THE BYE RACE

Doug's 100% playoff result is a simulation outcome, not a formal clinch. His bye chance is about 59%; Lij and Matt A are each about 18%. Two Week 9 wins raise Doug's bye odds to about 77%, while zero drop them to about 22%.

THE BUBBLE

Marc is 87% to get in but can still fall out. Brett (52%), Vlad (44%) and Derek (21%) are chasing the final places. The typical seventh seed finishes around 12 wins. Vlad's Week 9 sweep would lift him to about 64%; an 0-2 week cuts him to about 21%.

THE ROAD THAT DECIDES IT

WEEK	PRESSURE GAMES
9	Rolling With Mahomies (Matt Z) vs 9 - 5 (Doug) Taylor Swift (@EPBruette) vs WHO's YOUR VLADDY (Vlad)
10	my njigba (Derek) vs WHO's YOUR VLADDY (Vlad) 9 - 5 (Doug) vs Paper Kings (@13rett_t) Rudy (Paul) vs CTE (@MattIsGeneric)
11	Taylor Swift (@EPBruette) vs CTE (@MattIsGeneric) Rolling With Mahomies (Matt Z) vs Rudy (Paul) 9 - 5 (Doug) vs Walker? Barely know her (@_RE_Marc)

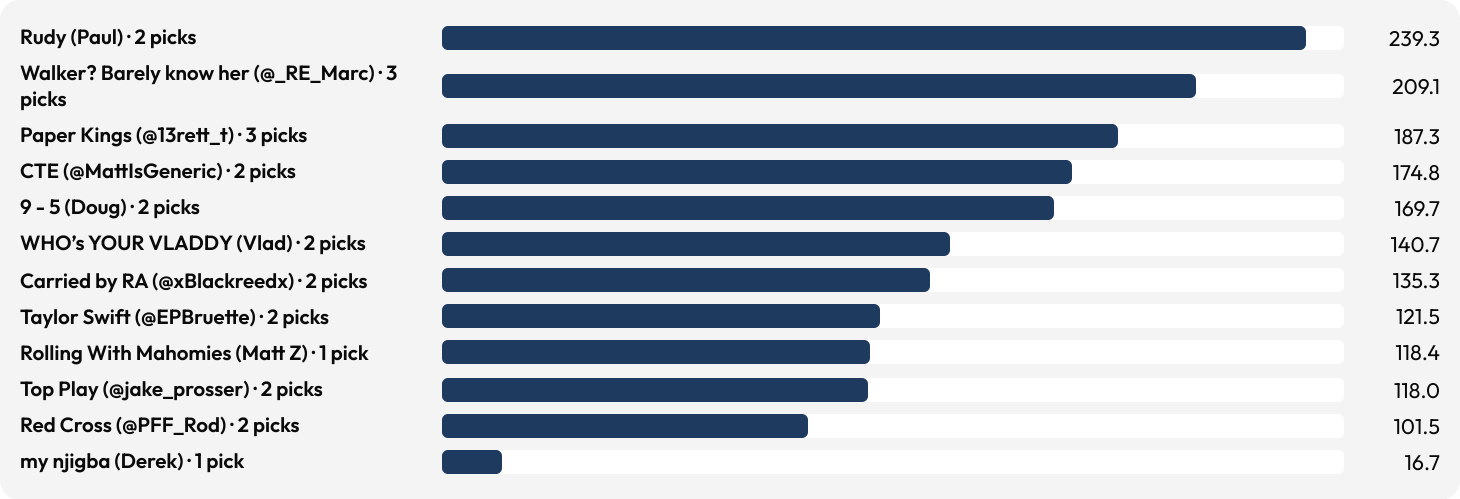
THE COMMISSIONER'S CORNER: 0-16

Top Play (@jake_prosser) is mathematically eliminated: six possible wins remain, and nine teams already have at least seven. Eight H2H losses, eight median losses, last in PF (647.36) and PD (−245.48). The 61.64 in Week 8 is the second-lowest team score of 2026; **Lij's 60.12 in Week 3 is the season low.**

The only race left is away from zero. The model gives Jake about a 32% chance of at least one result win over Weeks 9–11, with his best weekly chance now against Brett (~20%). Then come Marc and Derek. Even the winless host can wreck somebody else's playoff plans.

ROUND 1-2 REPORT CARD

Keepers were outside the draft. Here is what the actual first two rounds have produced through Week 8 — total player Flex points, not current-roster output. Pick counts differ, so totals are not an equal-investment grade.



Winner: Paul's Josh Allen at 1.11 has delivered 192.3 (QB1), driving his 239.3 total. **Value:** Higgins at 2.06 has 118.1 (WR4), while McBride at 2.11 has 118.4 (TE1). **Pain:** Achane has 21.1, Saquon 47.0 and A.J. Brown 14.6. Derek traded away his first and got just 16.7 from Price, his lone early pick. Brett's Henry (130.7) cannot erase Montgomery (42.0) and Brown.

WEEK 9: SIX GAMES, NO FREE SQUARES

GAME OF THE WEEK

ROLLING WITH MAHOMIES (MATT Z) VS 9 - 5 (DOUG)

Doug ~59% / Matt Z ~41%. The bye favorite meets the No. 4 Flex team; a Doug sweep would sharply tighten his grip.

HEAT CHECK

TAYLOR SWIFT (@EPBRUETTE) VS WHO'S YOUR VLADDY (VLAD)

Lij ~54% / Vlad ~46%. A six-result streak meets the board's four-place climber. Bye chase versus bubble survival.

FREE FALL BOWL

TOP PLAY (@JAKE_PROSSER) VS PAPER KINGS (@13RETT_T)

Brett ~80% / Jake ~20%. One needs playoff oxygen; the other needs any win at all.

BUBBLE PRESSURE

MY NJIGBA (DEREK) VS WALKER? BARELY KNOW HER (@_RE_MARC)

About 50/50. Derek needs ground; Marc needs to avoid turning an 87% playoff chance into a sweat.

SPOILER WATCH

RUDY (PAUL) VS RED CROSS (@PFF_ROD)

Paul ~95%. A heavily favored contender faces a 2-14 spoiler with little left to lose.

DEFEND THE CROWN

CTE (@MATTISGENERIC) VS CARRIED BY RA (@XBLACKREEDX)

Matt A ~82%. The new No. 1 follows 167.92 against a 5-11 opponent whose modeled playoff chance is near zero.

Thursday is already final: Jaguars 33, Ravens 10. Justice Hill led with 17.70 fantasy points.

Matchup probabilities are pre-Week 9 model estimates, not live post-TNF odds. Sources: Episode 5 rundown; Sleeper league 1311998258079371264 (Weeks 1–8); draft 1311998258083561472; Week 9 Flex JSON. Simulations use recent-weighted scoring, SD floor 12, scores clipped to 40–220, weekly median wins, and wins/PF seeding. No new live scores or injury updates were added.